

Matt Viana

Ph.D. Student in Informatics and Intelligent Systems

Curriculum Vitae

March 2026

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Education

Aug 2025 - Present	Ph.D. in Informatics and Intelligent Systems (Advisor: Dr. Dana Calacci) University Park, PA	Pennsylvania State University
Aug 2022 - May 2025	B.S. in Data Science, Minor in Computer Science University Park, PA	Pennsylvania State University

Research Experience

Aug 2025 - Present	Working Futures Network, Penn State Graduate Research Assistant	Supervisor: Dr. Dana Calacci
	➤ Investigate user behavior and adoption patterns of Large Language Models (LLMs) in real-world settings. ➤ Conduct qualitative research and system audits to identify security vulnerabilities and privacy concerns in AI systems. ➤ Develop novel user feedback mechanisms to mitigate AI mirroring behaviors such as sycophancy and perspective mimesis. ➤ Collaborate on research projects exploring the interpretability of 'black box' AI models.	
Feb 2024 - Jan 2025	Pennsylvania State University AI Research Assistant	Adviser: Dr. Sharon Huang
	➤ Fine-tuned large language models (LLMs) using TensorFlow and PyCharm, incorporating an improved dataset and model published on Hugging Face. ➤ Conducted a literature review on multimodal emotional classification and interaction in large language models (LLMs). ➤ Researched NLP and Computer Vision techniques, focusing on the development of models to analyze a wide emotional spectrum. ➤ Ran experiments integrating audio, visual, and textual inputs into language models, utilizing clustering techniques and data augmentation.	

Publications

2026	Interaction Context Often Increases Sycophancy in LLMs → S Jain, C Park, M M Viana, A Wilson, D Calacci <i>[CHI] ACM CHI 2026 (Honorable Mention)</i>
Draft	Active Negotiation: How Users Interact With and Adopt Large Language Models M Viana, P Erickson, D Calacci <i>Draft available upon request</i>
In Progress	How Context Influences LLM Assumptions M Viana, B Jain, D Calacci <i>Audit study investigating how extended conversation history triggers LLMs to infer user demographics</i>

In Progress

I Wish it Wouldn't Lie: Addressing Trust Eroding Design in LLMs
M Viana, D Calacci
Designing a multi-feature conversational interface to measure the impact of granular feedback

Awards & Funding

2026

Honorable Mention Award
Recipient
ACM CHI Conference

2025-2026

Rednor Graduate Fellowship
Fellow
College of Information Sciences and Technology

2025

ICDS Rising Researcher Grant
Recipient
Institute for Computational and Data Sciences, Pennsylvania State University

Invited Talks

Feb 2026

Guest Research Talk
University Park, PA

Plain Text Lab (Dr. Jonathan Dodge), Pennsylvania State University

Mentoring

June 2025 - Present

Patrick Erickson
Undergraduate B.S. in Data Science. Research project focused on the adoption and integration of LLMs.

Pennsylvania State University

Skills

- **Research Methods:** Qualitative Analysis, AI Auditing, User Studies, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)
- **Technical:** Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Natural Language Processing
- **Programming:** Python, R, SQL

Memberships

2025 - Present

Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)

2025 - Present

Center for Socially Responsible Artificial Intelligence (CSRAI)